

Effective Communication

Week 6

Learning Outcomes

In this week's lesson, you will:

- identify the elements of effective writing - clear, concise, concrete, cohesive and complete
- use the 5Cs when writing your Article
- write the Conclusion of the Article
- use tools to check grammar and plagiarism

Review E-Learning

1. Have you completed the following parts of the Article?

- Headings and subheadings?
- The Introduction?
- Discussion point 1?

2. Have you completed the paraphrasing, summarising & synthesising activity?

Article (30%)

Refer to Assessment Specifications

You are required to submit an Article of **550 - 650 words** on the theme and topic that you will be speaking about.

Date: 30 Jun 2026 (Week 11)

Time: 11.59 pm

Submit via LMS



What did we cover in
Weeks 3 & 5?

Recap

MAPS for Article

Completed!



What is the main **message** of my article?



Who is my **audience**?



What is the **purpose** of my article?



What **strategies** can I use to communicate my message most effectively?

Recap from Week 5 E-Learning

	Synthesising	Paraphrasing	Summarising
When do you use it?	▪ You want to demonstrate that you have a new idea that comes from different parts of the original text that have some overlap.	▪ You want to use all the ideas of the original text. ▪ The original is up to three sentences long.	▪ You want to use only the most important parts of the original text. ▪ The details are not important. ▪ The original text is longer than three sentences.
What do you do?	▪ Combine ideas obtained from different parts of the text to form a new idea.	▪ Retain the information in the original text.	▪ Decide which are the most important parts of the original text.
How do you present the writing?	▪ Write using your own words. ▪ Change the sentence structure and vocabulary. ▪ Seamlessly integrate your sentence into the writing. ▪ Do not use quotation marks.		

Recap: Persuasive Appeals

Aristotle's Art of Persuasion

ETHOS

Credibility



Trustworthiness
Authority
Credible Sources
Expertise
Reputation

PATHOS

Emotion



Feelings
Descriptive Language
Inspirational Quotes
Stories
Vivid Images

LOGOS

Logic



Fact-based Logical Arguments
Case Studies
Clear Structure
Data / Statistics
Evidence

Recap: Target the Audience

Who is reading your article?

- Students from the Institutes of Higher Learning (IHLs)
- Aged 17-22 years old (Gen Z)

Write for the audience

- Use language that is appropriate for the audience.
- Avoid technical jargon as you are writing for a general audience.



Recap: Purpose

What is the purpose of my article?

- To share my opinion about the topic and to generate discussion.





Recap: Structure of Article

Introduction

Discussion

Subheading 1

Subheading 2

Subheading 3

Conclusion

Recap: Introduction

Introduction

In June 2022, Deputy Prime Minister Lawrence Wong posted this message on social media, “Set your path, think about what you want to achieve and go for it with all your heart”. This reminded me of my dream of creating a new CCA. In my first year at Temasek Polytechnic (TP), I visited the CCA Fair and realised that out of the 77 CCAs in TP, none of them could fulfil my interest in visual arts and writing. This led me to create a CCA dedicated to the visual arts and writing. I’m proud to share that in 2022, my friends and I founded the Visual Arts and Writing Club (VAWC), a club that cultivates life skills, supports the community, and moulds leaders.

Introduce the **context/background** related to the topic

State the **main message** and discuss the **personal motivation**.

End with a statement that lists the **three reasons** that you are going to cover in the Discussion.

Recap: Discussion

Cultivating life skills

A new CCA that encourages creativity through visual arts and writing will help students cultivate important life skills.

One of the benefits of an arts education, as reported by [UNESCO](#), is the opportunity for students to innovate and problem-solve. These life skills teach students to embrace failure as part of the creative process, which is essential to developing a growth mindset. [MOE](#) Art teachers are also encouraged to help nurture students' growth mindset through arts.

In secondary school, I volunteered for an art project where I faced a challenge trying to display a poem on a painting. I solved this problem by carving the poem on a plastic sheet to create a stencil and projecting light through it.

I saw the value of problem-solving in a creative environment and am proud that VAWC allows students to cultivate these life skills.

P

E

E

L

Activity 1: Group discussion

Is this introduction appropriate for the audience (Gen Z in the IHLs)?

Topic: What I like about my neighbourhood

Context/ Background	INTRODUCTION Smart features, green technologies and inclusive design - these are some features that young people want in their living spaces, according to the Urban Redevelopment Authority (URA). Gen Zers like us can look forward to living in smart towns like Tengah equipped with HDB's latest green technologies. Although we appreciate these ultra-modern features, there is a growing number of Gen Zers who like nostalgia, according to McKinsey & Company. I am one of them.
Main message & motivation	I like my neighbourhood of Braddell Hill because it is old and has a unique charm which I hope can be preserved.
Three reasons	The qualities that make it special are the heritage sites, old-school restaurants, and its retro design. (113 words)



**This week: Effective Writing
Skills**

5 Cs

The 5Cs of Writing



Clear

Make deliberate word choices;
Construct well-formed sentences;
Use grammar correctly



Concise

Get to the point



Concrete

Provide concrete details that support the main idea



Cohesive

Use signal words, discourse markers, headings & subheadings to link points logically



Complete

Answer the 5Ws and 1H questions

The 5Cs of Writing

Think: Why are “cliches” not included?



Clear

Make deliberate word choices;
Construct well-formed sentences;
Use grammar correctly



Concise

Get to the point



Concrete

Provide concrete details that support the main idea



Cohesive

Use signal words, discourse markers, headings & subheadings to link points logically



Complete

Answer the 5Ws and 1H questions



Make deliberate word choices

Example 1: When you describe someone as good, what exactly do you mean?

Think of a word that can replace "good." How does it alter the message?

Hint: Use an online thesaurus to search for a **synonym of "good."**

Kind

Upright

Diligent

Responsible

Considerate



Make deliberate word choices

Example 2: When you say that you want to "**think**" about something, what do you mean?

Hint: Use an online thesaurus to search for a synonym for the verb "think".

How do the different shades of meaning affect a message?

Consider

Reflect

Ponder

Meditate

Conclude

Practice: Choose the best word to complete this sentence.

Gen Zers are ____ different from Millennials because of their **unique** definition of career success.

- A. very
- B. truly
- C. radically
- D. amazingly



Multiple Choice



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Clear

Construct well-formed sentences & use grammar correctly

Which of the following is a sentence? Why?

- A. He believed he could complete the race.
- B. Believing he could complete the race.
- C. To believe he could complete the race.



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Construct well-formed sentences & use grammar correctly

Which of the following sentences is correct in terms of structure?

A. Fast fashion is the term used to describe designs that follow the latest trends, the collections are often based on styles by high fashion brands.

B. Fast fashion is the term used to describe designs that follow the latest trends. The collections are often based on styles by high fashion brands.



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Concise

Redundancy



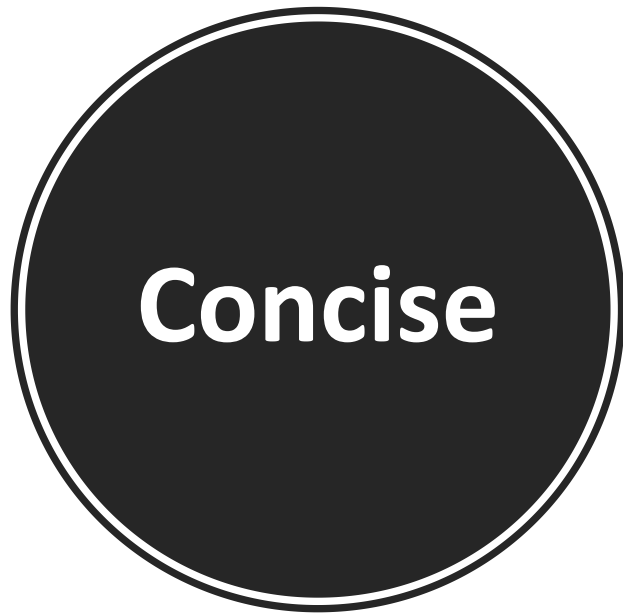
Unnecessary
Explanations

Overused
Phrases

Excess
Signposts

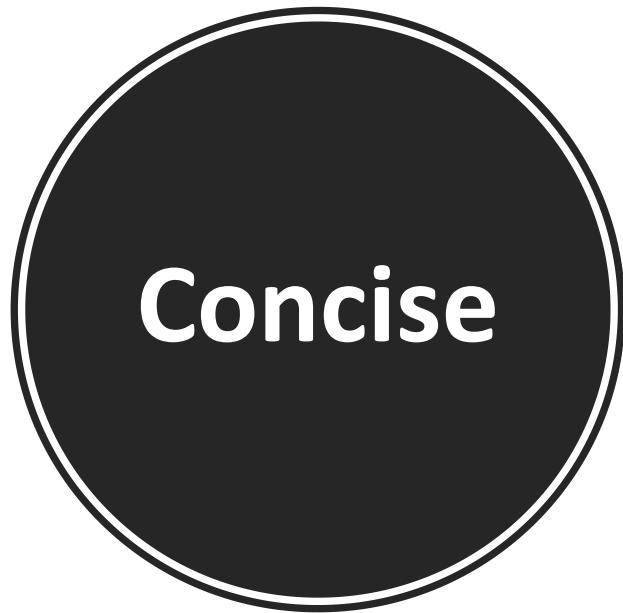
Extra Words

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CHgdvQYXQck>



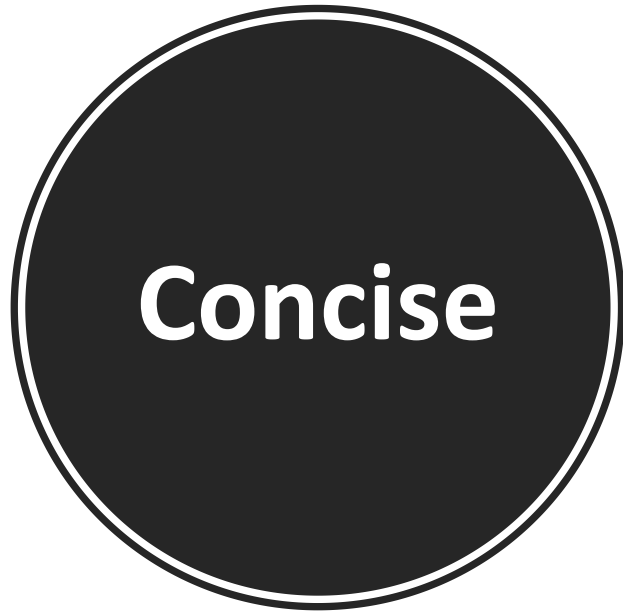
Summary

Common phrase	Replacement
Regardless of the fact that	Although
Due to the fact that	Because
Under the circumstances in which	When
Concerning the matter of	About/Regarding



Summary

Original	Concise version
<u>In this paper</u>, I will argue that while the main reason for the expedition's great success was careful planning, <u>three other factors</u> played very important roles. <u>To begin with</u>, all members of the team were veteran climbers. <u>It must be added</u> that their gear served them well. <u>Finally</u>, the weather was unusually good.	While the main reason for the expedition's great success was careful planning, three other factors played very important roles: all members of the team were veteran climbers, their gear served them well, and the weather was unusually good.



Summary

Original	Concise version
Unexpected surprise	Surprise
Terrible disaster	Disaster
Completely finished	Finished
Free gift	Gift
Past memories	Memories

Practice: Write Concisely

1. Read the statements below and identify the main points.
2. What is the best way of rewriting them concisely in one sentence?

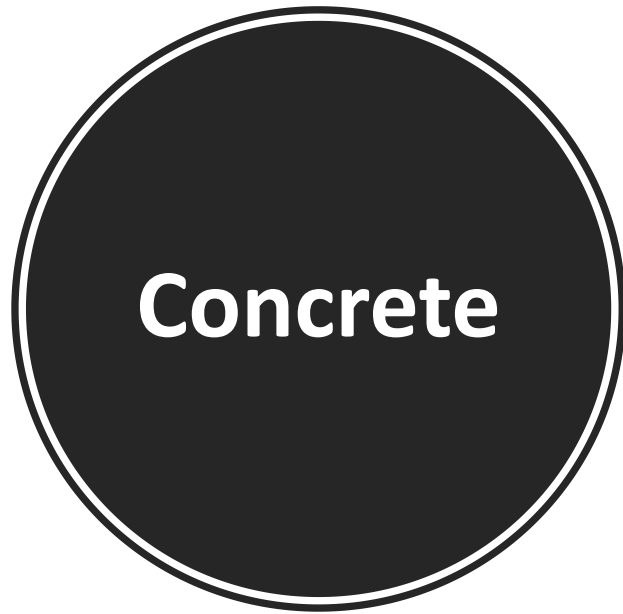
“Instagram is something that we can never get bored with because of the number of features available for users to use. The features are what make the app user-friendly and fun.” (31 words)



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Short Answer



Provide concrete details that support the main idea

- Avoid being vague or ambiguous.
- Eliminate vague pronoun references.
- “This” or “it” – these references may not be clear to the reader. Replace vague words with specific ones to make your writing concrete.

Vague	Concrete
Researchers at A*STAR will work with another company to make reusable face masks.	Researchers at A*STAR will work with local textile and apparel manufacturer Ramatex to make reusable face masks.

Practice: Write Concretely

Choose the most concrete description for ‘large amounts’ in the list.

The fast fashion industry is responsible for **large amounts** of textile waste.

- A. Much of the textile waste is burnt or buried in landfills.
- B. Some of the textile waste consists of items that had never reached the consumer.
- C. The fast fashion industry produces about 92 million tonnes of textiles waste annually.



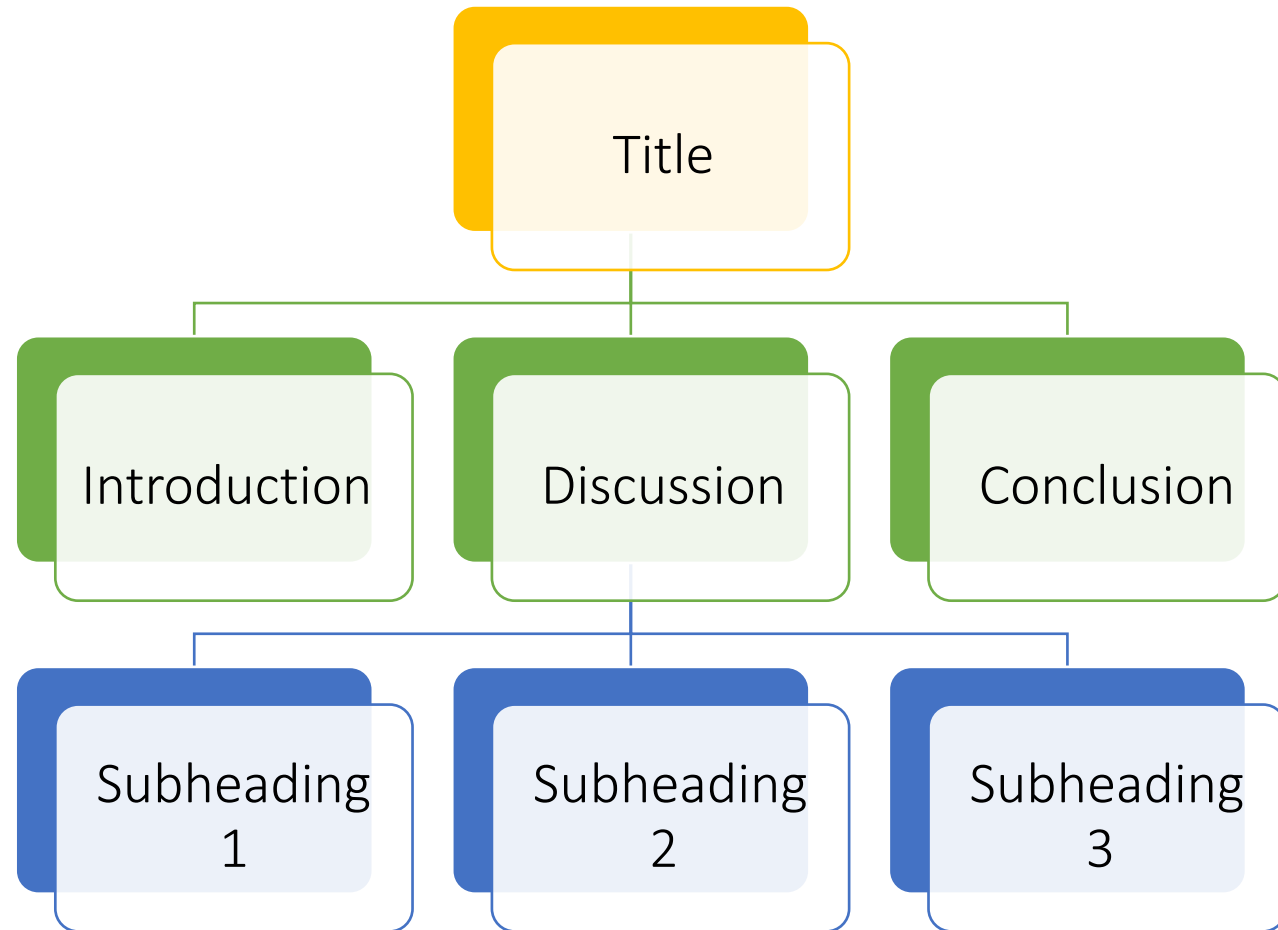
Multiple Choice



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Headings & Subheadings





Signal Words

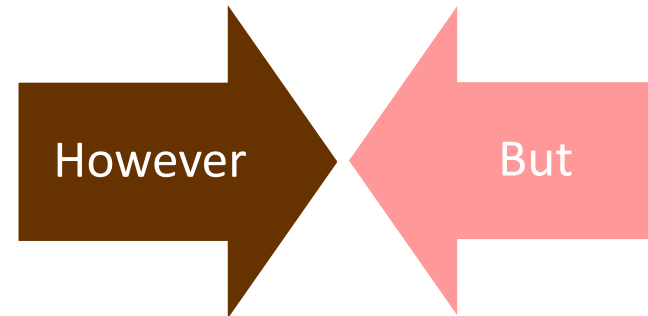
To list



To add



To show contrast



To show reason or
cause & effect





Signal Words

Time	Space	Cause & effect	Similarity	Contrast
Before, after, during, while, until	Above, below, inside	As a result, because, since	As, likewise, similarly	Although, however, on the other hand

Practice: Identify three cohesive devices in this text

Write them in the word cloud.

Advantages of Artificial Intelligence

Reduction in Human Error

One of the biggest advantages of Artificial Intelligence (AI) is that it reduces errors and increases accuracy and precision.

Zero Risks

Another advantage is that AI can be deployed in high-risk work, like space exploration or in search and rescue missions. Moreover, they will complete the tasks responsibly.

24x7 Availability

Thirdly, AI can work endlessly without breaks. Many studies show that humans are productive for three to four hours in a day, but, AI can work for many more hours.

Complete

5W and 1H questions.

Writing completely means answering the **5W and 1H questions.**

What? Where? Who? When? Why? And How?





Review: Writing strategies

5Cs

1. **Clear**: Is my word choice effective? Are my sentences well-constructed?
2. **Concise** – What are the relevant points to include? What is redundant?
3. **Concrete** – What concrete details must I include to make my article convincing?
4. **Cohesive** – What devices should I use to ensure that my ideas and sentences & paragraphs are linked?
5. **Complete** – Which of the 5W and 1 H questions do I need to answer so that the information is complete?

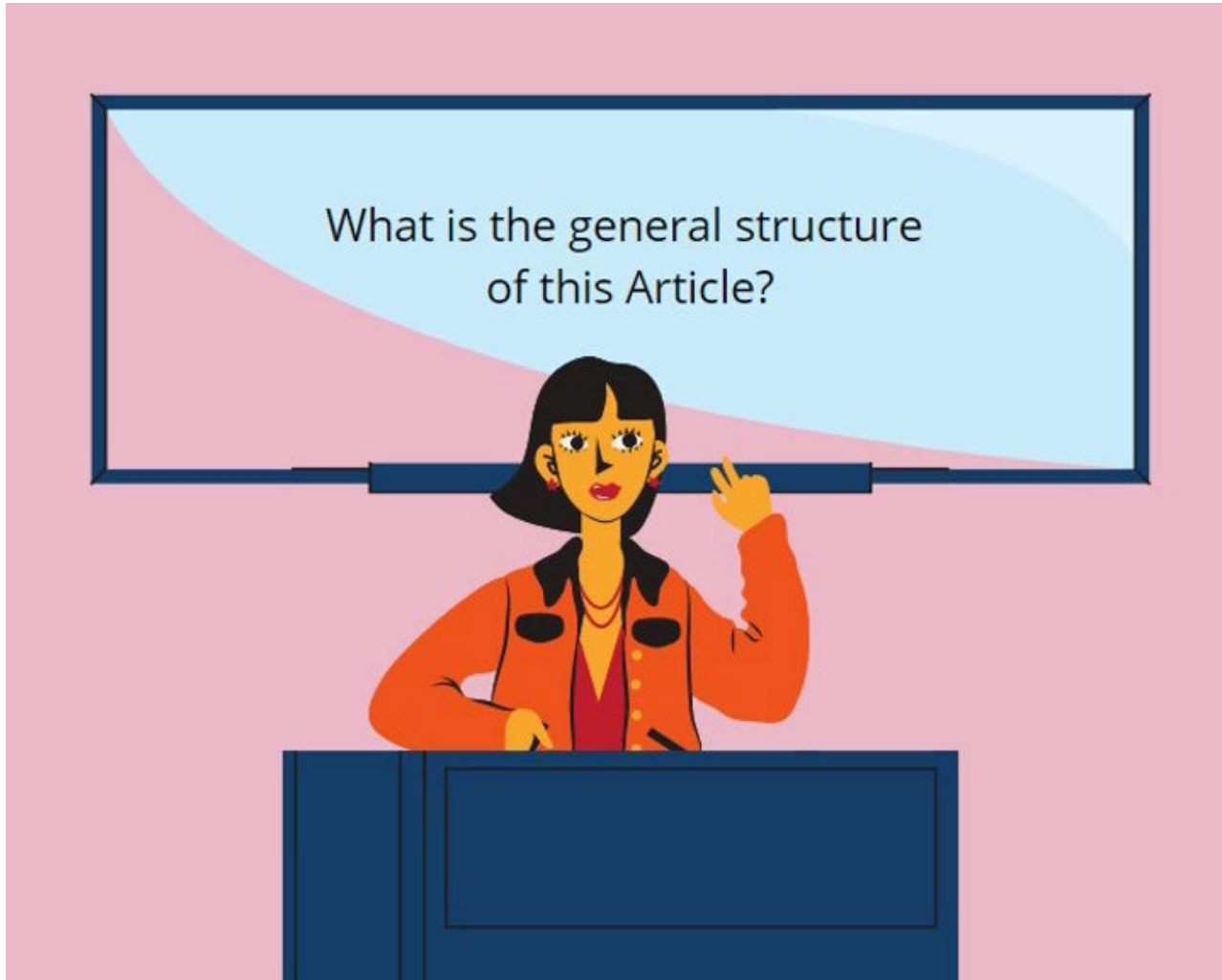
Activity 2

How will you improve the writing strategies in your article?

Review the introduction or the first discussion point in your draft and improve it using one or more of the Cs.



Recap: Structure of Article



INTRODUCTION

DISCUSSION

Subheading 1

Subheading 2

Subheading 3

CONCLUSION

Writing the Conclusion

CONCLUSION (Things to include)

- **(Summary)** Reiterate the main message and the three reasons.
- **(CTA)** Include a call to action (CTA) of the seminar and details.

Writing the Conclusion

Conclusion (50 – 80 words)

Conclusion

An achievement I'm most proud of is the creation of VAWC as this CCA cultivates life skills, supports the community, and provides leadership opportunities for members.

To find out more about our achievements, join the TP Talks seminar series on Monday, 3 August 2026 at 9am in TP's Auditorium 3.

Reiterate the main message
Summarise the three reasons

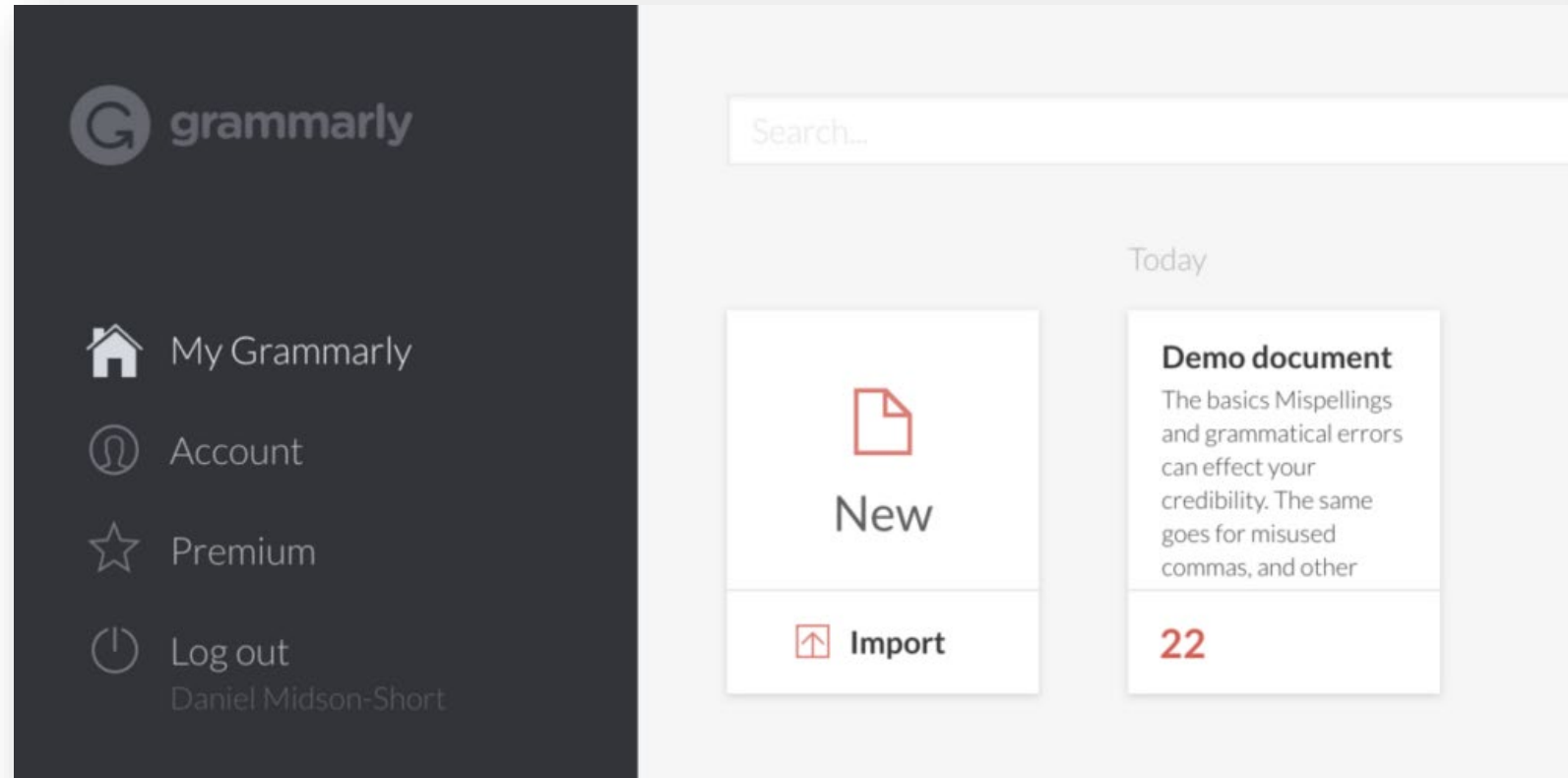
CTA: Include a call to action (CTA) of the seminar and details.



Tools to check grammar & plagiarism

Using Grammarly

- Create a free account at <https://app.grammarly.com>
- Upload your Word document or copy and paste your text into Grammarly



Using Grammarly

- Set the Goals to get tailored writing suggestions.

Set goals

Get tailored writing suggestions based on your goals and audience.

Audience **General** Knowledgeable Expert

General: Easy for anyone to read with minimal effort.

Formality Informal Neutral **Formal**

Formal: Restricts slang and colloquialisms.

Domain Academic Business **General** Email Casual Creative

General (default): Applies most rules and conventions with medium strictness.

Intent **Inform** Describe Convince Tell A Story

Experimental. What are you trying to do? This helps us build new suggestions and won't affect your feedback today.

☒ Show Set Goals when I start a new document [Reset to defaults](#) [Done](#)

98
Overall score
See performance >

Goals
Adjust goals >

All suggestions

Correctness ✓
Looking good

Clarity
Very clear

Engagement
Engaging

Delivery ✓
Just right

Style guide ✓

Using Grammarly

- Click on 'Overall Score' to see Grammarly's analysis of the quality of your writing.

The screenshot displays the Grammarly interface with a central analysis panel and a right-hand sidebar. The central panel is titled 'Performance' and shows a 'Text score: 98 out of 100'. Below this, the 'Word Count' section lists: Characters (697), Words (110), Sentences (6), Reading time (26 sec), and Speaking time (50 sec). The 'Readability' section shows: Word length (5.2), Sentence length (18.3), and a Readability score of 45. A note at the bottom states: 'Your text compares in readability to The New York Times. It is likely to be understood by a reader who has at least a 10th-grade education (age 16).' The right-hand sidebar features a '98 Overall score' box at the top, followed by 'Goals', 'All suggestions', 'Correctness' (Looking good), 'Clarity' (Very clear), 'Engagement' (Engaging), 'Delivery' (Just right), 'Style guide', and 'Plagiarism'. A 'Close' button is located at the bottom right of the central panel.

Performance

Text score: 98 out of 100. This score represents the quality of writing in this document. You can increase it by addressing Grammarly's suggestions.

Word Count

Characters	697	Reading time	26 sec
Words	110	Speaking time	50 sec
Sentences	6		

Readability

Metrics compared to other Grammarly users

Word length	5.2	Above average
Sentence length	18.3	Above average
Readability score	45	

Your text compares in readability to The New York Times. It is likely to be understood by a reader who has at least a 10th-grade education (age 16).

[DOWNLOAD PDF REPORT](#) [Close](#)

98 Overall score
See performance

Goals
Adjust goals

All suggestions

Correctness ✓
Looking good

Clarity
Very clear

Engagement
Engaging

Delivery ✓
Just right

Style guide ✓

Plagiarism

Using Grammarly

- Click on 'Correctness' and 'Clarity' to see Grammarly's suggested edits.

The screenshot displays the Grammarly interface. On the left, the 'Correctness' section is active, showing a list of suggestions. The first suggestion is 'Correctness · Change the spelling', with the text '...red-green color colour blindness,...' and an 'Accept' button. Below it are two more suggestions: 'Change the spelling colors' and 'Change the spelling color'. On the right, a sidebar shows the 'Overall score' as 93, 'Goals' as 4 of 4 set, and 'GrammarlyGO AI text generation'. At the bottom, a yellow-bordered box highlights the 'All suggestions' summary, which includes 'Correctness' with 39 alerts and 'Clarity' with a 'Very clear' status and a checkmark.

39 Correctness Back to all suggestions

Correctness · Change the spelling

...red-green **color** **colour** blindness,...

Accept Dismiss ...

Change the spelling colors

Change the spelling color

93 Overall score
See performance

Goals
4 of 4 set

GrammarlyGO
AI text generation

All suggestions

Improves spelling, grammar, and punctuation.

Helps make your writing easier to understand.

Correctness
39 alerts

Clarity
Very clear

Article:

How to use
digital tools to
edit your article

Edit Essays Faster | Grammarly

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xmmfWcR65kl>





Peer Review & Consultation

- Refer to the Peer Review Checklist for Article in LMS
- Peer Review the Introduction & Discussion from Week 5 E-Learning
- Using the Grammarly tool, improve your Article

Article Submission (30%) Week 11



End of Week 6 – Draft submission



Week 7 – Consultation with tutor



Use digital tools (e.g. Grammarly) to check language



Week 11 – Submit the Article on LMS



Week 11 onwards – Prepare for the Seminar Presentation

Tips for your Article

Discussion



P

Point: Write down one main idea/reason about your topic

E

Example: Give an example to illustrate your point

E

Explain/Evaluate/Elaborate on the point (with personal input)

L

Conclude the paragraph by linking back to the main idea

Week 6 E-Learning

1. Complete the E-Learning lesson.
2. Edit and improve your Article.
3. Continue Reason 2 and 3, and the Conclusion.
4. Include the relevant visuals to support the information in the Article.
5. Complete the Checklist for Article.
6. Complete the pre-consultation activity.
7. Submit the full draft of your Article according to your tutor's instructions.
8. Your tutor will only provide **ONE** round of feedback.

